Scouting America

Shotgun Shooting Merit Badge Workbook

SCOUTMASTER BUCKY

Scouts participating in a Scoutmaster Bucky merit badge opportunity, whether online or in person, should consider using the Shotgun Shooting merit badge pamphlet for discovery and knowledge, along with the class preparation pages for clarifications, insights, and expectations.

https://scoutmasterbucky.com/merit-badges/shotgun-shooting/shotgun-shooting-pamphlet.pdf

https://scoutmasterbucky.com/merit-badges/shotgun-shooting/shotgun-shooting-cpp.pdf

REQUIREMENT 1a:	Explain what a projectile is.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1a:	Explain why any device that shoots a projectile at high speed must be handled with care and respect, and used only in approved locations.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1b:	Explain the basic rules of safe gun handling that apply to all firearms.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1c:	Describe how you would react if a friend visiting your home asked to see your or your family's firearm.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1d:	Explain the need for, types, and use of eye protection and hearing protection.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1e:	Explain the main points of the laws for owning and using guns in your community and state.
Community:	
State:	

REQUIREMENT 1f:	Explain how hunting is related to the wise use of renewable wildlife resources.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1g:	Successfully complete a state hunter education course, or obtain a copy of the hunting laws for your state.

Be sure to bring the appropriate documentation to share with your counselor

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 1g1:	Explain the main points of hunting laws in your state, and any special laws on the use of guns and ammunition.

Main Points of State Hunting Laws:

Special State Laws for use of Guns or Ammunition:

REQUIREMENT 1g2:	List the kinds of wildlife that can be legally hunted in your state.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 1h:	Explain to your counselor the proper hygienic guidelines followed while shooting.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 1i:	List and explain three shotgun sports. Identify places in your community where you could practice these sports, and explain how you can join or be a part of range and target activities.
SHOTGUN SPORT #1:	
Practice Location in Community:	
Activities:	
SHOTGUN SPORT #2:	
Practice Location in Community:	
Activities:	
SHOTGUN SPORT #3:	
Practice Location in Community:	
Activities:	

REQUIREMENT 1j:	Discuss with your counselor a list of sources you could contact for information on firearms and their use.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2:	Working under the supervision of a certified National Rifle Association (NRA) Shotgun instructor and a certified range safety officer, at a nationally authorized camp property or at a commercial firearm range (as defined in the Scouting America National Range and Target Activities Manual), do ONE of the following options:

DO ONE OF THE FOLLOWING (2A or 2B) FOR REQUIREMENT 2

Requirement 2A - Shotgun Shooting (Modern Shotshell Type) Option

REQUIREMENT 2aa:	Identify and explain the principal parts of a shotgun, action types, and how they function.

Notes:

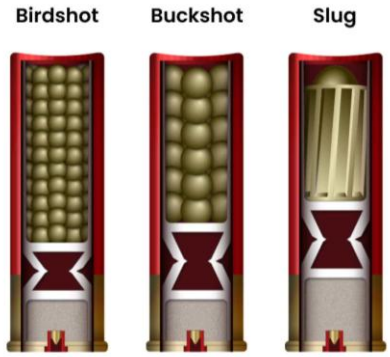
REQUIREMENT 2ab:	Identify and demonstrate the rules for safely storing and handling a shotgun.

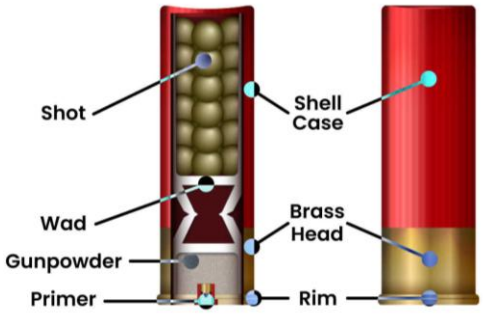
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

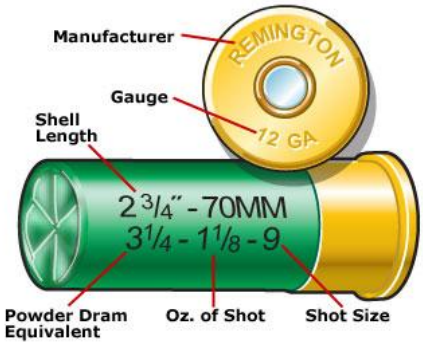
BE PREPARED!

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2ac: Identify the parts of a shotgun shell and their functions.







Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2ad:	Identify the various gauges of shotguns. Explain which you would choose for a particular use and why.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2ae:	Identify the causes of a shotgun's failure to fire
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2ae:	Explain misfire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Misfire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	

REQUIREMENT 2ae:	Explain hangfire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Hangfire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	
REQUIREMENT 2ae:	Explain squib fire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Squib Fire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	

REQUIREMENT 2af:	Demonstrate the knowledge, skills, and attitude necessary to safely shoot a shotgun on a range, including understanding and following range procedures and commands.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 2ag:	Explain the basic safety rules for cleaning a shotgun.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2ag:	Identify the materials needed for cleaning a shotgun.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2ah:	Demonstrate how to clean a shotgun properly and safely.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 2ai:	Discuss what points you would consider in selecting a shotgun.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2aj:	Shoot a moving target while following the rules and achieving the required score listed in (k) with a shotgun using the four fundamentals of firing a shot—position, mount, vision, and movement.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 2ak: Shooting score required: Hit at least 12 out of 25 targets (48 percent) in two 25-target groups. The two groups need not be shot in consecutive order. A minimum of 50 shots must be fired. Shooting skill rules:

- Targets may be thrown by a hand trap, manual mechanical trap, or on any trap or skeet field. If using a hand trap or manual mechanical trap, the trap operator should be at least 5 feet to the right and 3 feet to the rear of the shooter. If throwing left-handed with a hand trap, the trap operator should be at least 5 feet to the left and 3 feet to the rear of the shooter.
- All targets should be thrown at a reasonable speed and in the same direction.
- Targets should be generally thrown so as to climb in the air after leaving the trap.
- Scores may be fired at any time, either in formal competition or in practice, but only under approved supervision and at an approved range as noted in the Scouting America National Range and Target Activities Manual.
- Modern, age-appropriate, target shotgun models, 12-, 16- or 20-gauge, may be used.
- Only commercially manufactured ammunition may be used. Reloads may not be used in Scouting America range and target activities.
- Shooters must shoot in rounds of 25. Rounds need not be shot continuously or on the same day. The term "round" refers to a single series of 25 shots.
- If using a trap field, shoot station 3 with traps set to throw straightaway targets.
- If using a skeet field, shoot station 7 low house.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

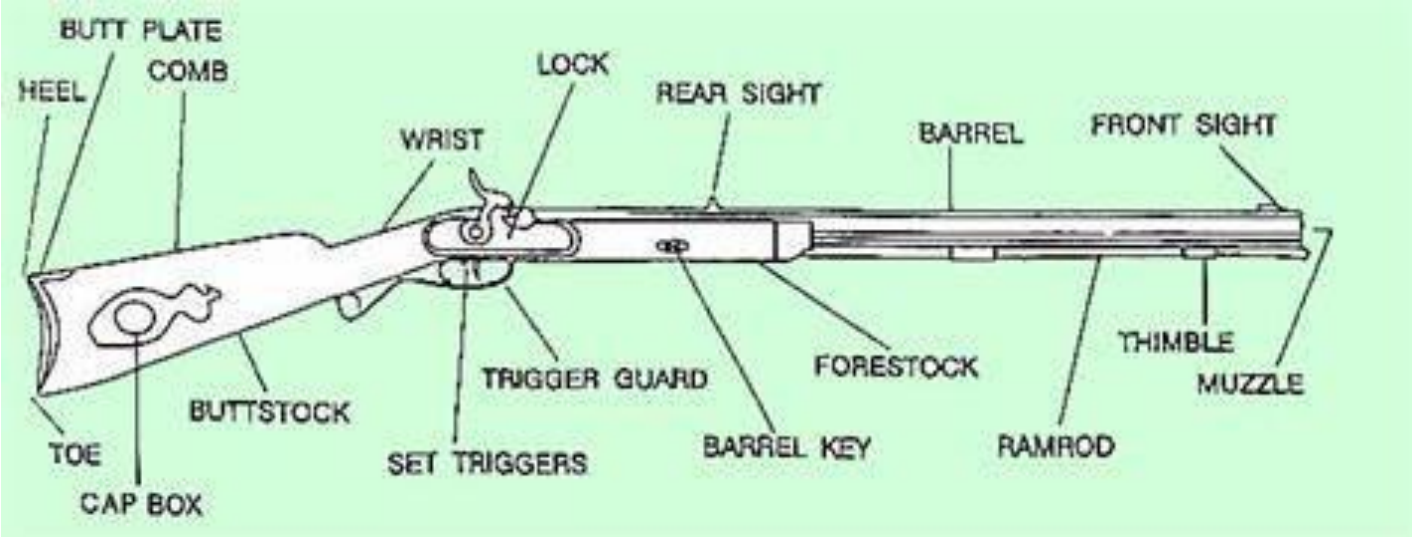
BE PREPARED!

Requirement 2B - Muzzleloading Shotgun Shooting Option

REQUIREMENT 2ba: Discuss with your counselor a brief history of the development of the muzzleloading shotgun.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bb: Identify principal parts of muzzleloading shotguns and discuss how they function.



Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bc: Identify and demonstrate the rules for safely storing and handling a muzzleloading shotgun.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bd: Identify the various grades of black powder and explain their proper and safe use.

Black powder are chunks of a dark gray to black powder. The size of the chunks is measured in "F"s. The finest powder is FFFFg, the large lumps are called Whaling or Cannon Powder. The grain size is compareable to the screen mesh size of how many wires per inch are used to sift the powder. The higher the mesh number the smaller the opening. The "g" indicates the granules were tumbled with graphite to smooth and polish the edges. The larger the granules the slower the burn rate of the powder.

Powder Grade	Mesh Size Per inch
Cannon	6 mesh
Fg	12 mesh
FFg	16 mesh
FFFg	20 mesh
FFFFg	40 mesh

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2be: Discuss proper safety procedures pertaining to black powder storage.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bf:	Discuss proper components of a load.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2bg:	Identify proper procedures and accessories used for safely loading a muzzleloading shotgun.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2bh:	Identify the causes of a muzzleloading shotgun's failure to fire
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2bh:	Explain misfire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Misfire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	

REQUIREMENT 2bh:	Explain hangfire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Hangfire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	
REQUIREMENT 2bh:	Explain squib fire then explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures and procedure to follow.
Squib Fire:	
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	
Preventative measure and procedure to follow:	

REQUIREMENT 2bh:	Explain and demonstrate proper preventive measures, and the procedures to follow in response to each.

Notes:

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bi:	Demonstrate the knowledge, skills, and attitude necessary to safely shoot a muzzleloading shotgun on a range, including understanding and following range procedures and commands.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 2bj:	Explain the basic safety rules for cleaning a muzzleloading shotgun.

Notes:

REQUIREMENT 2bj:	Identify the materials needed for cleaning a muzzleloading shotgun.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2bk:	Demonstrate how to clean a muzzleloading shotgun properly and safely.
This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor. **BE PREPARED!**	

REQUIREMENT 2bl:	Discuss what points you would consider in selecting a muzzleloading shotgun.
Notes:	

REQUIREMENT 2bm:	Shoot a moving target while following the rules and achieving the required score listed in (n) with a muzzleloading shotgun using the four fundamentals of firing a shot—position, mount, vision, and movement.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!

REQUIREMENT 2bn: Shooting score required: Hit at least 5 out of 15 targets in each of two 15-target groups. The two groups need not be shot in consecutive order. A minimum of 30 shots must be fired. Shooting skill rules:

- Targets may be thrown by a hand trap, manual mechanical trap, or on any trap or skeet field. If using a hand trap or manual mechanical trap, the trap operator should be at least 5 feet to the right and 3 feet to the rear of the shooter. If throwing left-handed with a hand trap, the trap operator should be at least 5 feet to the left and 3 feet to the rear of the shooter.
- All targets should be thrown at a reasonable speed and in the same direction.
- Targets should be generally thrown so as to climb in the air after leaving the trap.
- Scores may be fired at any time, either in formal competition or in practice, but only under approved supervision and at an approved range as noted in the Scouting America National Range and Target Activities Manual.
- A 10 gauge or smaller muzzleloading rifle in appropriate size for the participant may be used. Matchlock, wheellock, or flintlock firearms are not approved.
- Standard clay targets customarily used for trap and skeet are to be used.
- On a standard trap field, the shooter should be positioned 8 yards behind the trap house.
- The trap should be set to throw only straightaway targets.
- If using a skeet field, shoot station 7 low house.

This requirement must be reviewed with your merit badge counselor.

BE PREPARED!